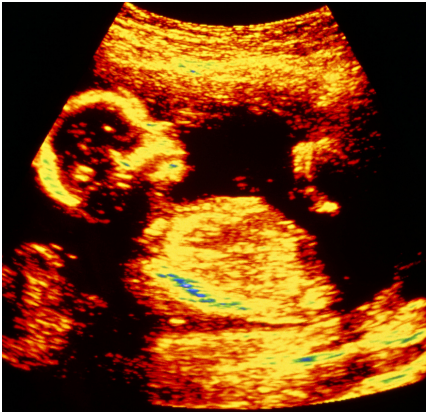




YOU ARE **18 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

150 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This is a side view ultrasound scan with the baby's head in the top left. Your baby appears completely human with all fingers and toes fully developed. The skin is now covered with lanugo, fine protective hair.

“There’s no harm in encouraging your baby to move to increase the likelihood of you feeling his wiggles.”

If you’re waiting to feel your baby’s first movements, be patient. Although it’s reassuring to feel them wiggling around, becoming stressed about it won’t be good for either of you. Remember, many pregnant women—first-time moms especially—don’t feel those first flutterings until 18 to 20 weeks or later (see [You are 19 weeks and 3 days](#)).

It may be that you have been so busy and active that you have been distracted and not felt your baby’s movements. So just stop and relax for a little while; when you’re resting the movements will be much more obvious. Also remember that the baby does not move continuously and there will be periods when the baby is not moving.

There are a few things you can try to stimulate your baby into action—the more they move, the more chances there are that you’ll feel it. It may help to lie down on your side, with your belly supported. If all else fails, sit down and rest while you have something sweet to eat or drink. This may just do the trick, because babies respond to a rise in their mother’s blood sugar.

ASK A DOCTOR

Can I prompt my baby to move by playing loud music? Your baby cannot hear yet, so playing loud music won’t have any effect. By about 22 weeks, they will be able to hear some sounds, by 24–25 weeks they’ll be reacting to many sounds, and sudden noises may prompt a “startle” response (see [Talking to your baby](#)).